Christian Experiences and Beliefs

A Checklist

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Name: _____ **Date:** _____

Instructions: Read each statement and check all that apply to you. If a statement does not apply, leave it blank.

Childhood Church Experience

- ☐ I attended church regularly as a child (approximately weekly).
- ☐ I liked going to church as a child.
- ☐ As a child, my church was very conservative and legalistic (focused on rules).
- ☐ I went to Vacation Bible School as a child.
- ☐ As a child, I took confirmation classes or studied for my first communion.
- ☐ As a child, I never really understood what church was about.

Family and Parental Faith

- ☐ One or both of my parents claimed to be a Christian.
- ☐ One or both of my parents worked in part-time or full-time Christian ministry.
- ☐ My parents were both devout Christians.
- ☐ As a child, although my parents went to church, they did not really live Christian lives.
- ☐ My parents were openly hostile toward church and God.
- ☐ I am a preacher's kid (PK).
- ☐ I am a missionary kid (MK).
- ☐ Although my parents never went to church, someone else took me.
- ☐ My parents prayed with me as a child and taught me to pray.

Youth Experience

- ☐ As a youth, I regularly participated in my church youth group.
- ☐ As a youth, I went on mission trips with my youth group.
- ☐ As a youth, my parents had to force me to go to church.
- ☐ As a youth, I wasn't allowed to go to dances or listen to non-Christian music.

Prayer and the Holy Spirit

- ☐ As an adult, I pray on a regular daily basis.
- ☐ I believe in the power of prayer and that God can perform miracles when we pray.
- ☐ I don't know much about the "Holy Spirit."
- ☐ I feel the presence of the Holy Spirit in my life.

- ☐ I believe in the power of prayer.
- ☐ I believe that God answers our prayers.
- ☐ I have an active and ongoing prayer life.

Confession, Forgiveness, and Sin

- ☐ I believe that you should regularly confess your sins to a priest.
- ☐ I believe that communion bread and wine actually turn into the body and blood of Christ.
- ☐ I believe that Jesus can forgive all sins, no matter how "bad" they are.
- ☐ I believe that once Jesus forgives my sins, God is not even aware of them.
- ☐ I believe that some sins are worse than other sins.
- ☐ I believe that all human beings sin, even "born again" Christians.

Doubt, Suffering, and God's Justice

- ☐ I am having a crisis of faith. I don't know what I believe anymore.
- ☐ If God is "all loving," I don't understand why good people suffer.
- ☐ I believe that pain and suffering can be good for human beings.
- ☐ I believe that if I follow God, I will be rewarded with money and prosperity.

Childhood Relationship with God

- ☐ When I look back on my childhood, I feel that Christianity was forced on me as a child.
- ☐ As a child, no one ever taught me about God.
- ☐ Since my earliest childhood memories, I have loved the Lord.
- ☐ As a child, I felt God's love at church.
- ☐ I gave my life to God as a child and had a "born again" experience.
- ☐ I studied the Bible and learned Bible verses as a child.
- ☐ As a child, I cried out to God, but He didn't answer me.
- ☐ I feel I was abused by Christians as a child.
- ☐ As a child, I never really believed in God.
- ☐ As a child, I thought of God as someone who would punish you if you were bad.

Core Doctrine and Scripture

- ☐ I believe that the Bible is flawless (inerrant), the perfect Word of God.
- ☐ I have my doubts about the Old Testament, but I believe in the New Testament.
- ☐ I believe that Jesus Christ was God, and not just a wise man.
- ☐ I believe in the teachings of Christ, but deep down I don't really think He was God.
- ☐ I believe that God is omnipotent (all powerful) and omniscient (all knowing).
- ☐ I believe in the life, death, and resurrection of Jesus Christ.
- ☐ I believe that Jesus Christ died for my sins.
- ☐ I believe that if children die without knowing Jesus, they will still go to heaven.
- ☐ I believe that there is an actual place called hell.
- ☐ I believe I will see my family again once I die and go to heaven.

Salvation and Assurance

- ☐ I consider myself to be a "born again" Christian.

- ☐ I have my doubts that heaven really exists.
- ☐ I have doubts about whether I am really saved.
- ☐ I believe “once saved, always saved.” You can’t lose your salvation once you are saved.
- ☐ I believe that God has chosen certain people to be saved and not others.
- ☐ I believe you can “backslide” and lose your salvation (even if you were once saved).
- ☐ I really don’t have to worry about anything I do, because I am “saved.”

Miracles

- ☐ I believe in miracles.
- ☐ I believe that miracles only happened in the times of Jesus and His apostles.
- ☐ God has performed miracles in my life.

Guilt, Judgment, and Self-Forgiveness

- ☐ I believe that all mental illness is a result of the person’s sin.
- ☐ I believe that there are always consequences for sin.
- ☐ I believe that God is punishing me for my sins.
- ☐ Although I know that God forgives sins, I can’t seem to forgive myself.

Present Relationship with God

- ☐ I feel close to God and His presence.
- ☐ I feel I have drifted away from God and His influence on my life.
- ☐ I used to feel close to God, but now I feel He is very far away.
- ☐ I have almost given up hope that God will rescue me.

For use in counseling and training. Not a diagnostic instrument.